

Does anyone avoid using ChatGPT because of its water usage?

Posted by u/Sad_Butterscotch7063 • 0 points • 1044 comments

Hey, I recently came across something about how using ChatGPT and similar AI tools actually consumes a surprising amount of water (cooling data centers, I guess). Made me wonder, have people here stopped or reduced using it because of that?

Curious how others are thinking about it in terms of sustainability and personal impact.

Comments

u/ExoG198765432 • 1 points • 2025-05-29 21:02 UTC

Check out r/aintiai

u/Accomplished-Day5145 • 1 points • 2025-05-27 11:15 UTC

You ask Gemini or or apple I and they both will say there are concerns about water shave but it will not tell you an answer

u/MisstressKDreamscape • 1 points • 2025-05-13 22:53 UTC

I guess what I want to ask is perhaps the issues aren't with ai but the fact that capitalism causes much more harm than it causes good outcomes. I've been going down the chatgpt rabbit hole and have started to question other things for example how much energy do gaming servers consume, how much "energy" does it cost to build a game, release dlc etc. Someone mentioned Shein their working conditions etc and now I'm thinking about streaming services, global tourism and emigration.

And yea I love living in delulu land thinking that I dont impact the world that vastly...but now I realize/ keep coming back to how much impact one human has on the environment. I also start thinking does that mean I have to stop all of the pursuits that I'm interested in or stop having goals? Do I stop being creative because art also has a huuuuge impact on the environment. I'm also a hairstylist/ barber hair color is one of my recent discoveries and color formulation is becoming an intense focus for me I love it so much. But I can't stop thinking about the waste and the landfill usage and all of these other things.

Sometimes its easier for me to justify things because "while I do x I dont do y" but I truly think that that can be a slippery slope to. Maybe it truly does boil down to being conscious of your impact and deciding what to do in each moment. I mean shit...how much energy does reddit use eek

u/Select_Change_247 • 1 points • 2025-04-11 20:55 UTC

Yes and because it's actively destroying democracy and human cognitive ability.

u/Localboy97355 • 1 points • 2025-04-08 16:42 UTC

How much water is used with ChatGPT vs a burger?

u/lazyegg37 • 1 points • 2025-04-08 03:21 UTC

yes!! i used to use it heavily until i learned abt the environmental impact

u/jorymil • 1 points • 2025-04-07 05:12 UTC

Energy usage, cooling infrastructure, plagiarism: there are tons of good reasons not to use generative AI right now. We talk about energy burden, but any time you convert energy between forms, some of it gets changed into heat, and that heat has to be removed from the system. There's a reason that power plants are located near large sources of water.

u/alcoholic_icecream • 1 points • 2025-04-06 12:32 UTC

I use ChatGPT, it's really good for some tasks. But I try to do a normal search before using ChatGPT. I wish ChatGPT not defaults to the large models (I didn't found a way to make it use smaller models before using the large one quota).

I wanna look at DeepSeek, because I heard it's lightweight enough to run locally.

u/IndusLeona • 1 points • 2025-04-06 02:36 UTC

I did. I deleted my account a while ago for the same reason.

u/rogben19 • 1 points • 2025-04-06 00:22 UTC

ChatGPT saved my gpa

u/Dark-Spell-4569 • 1 points • 2025-04-06 07:15 UTC

But it sabotages your ability to learn in the same stroke.

u/rogben19 • 1 points • 2025-04-06 13:42 UTC

Not really. It breaks down every chemistry problem I ask it and explains the concepts and rules in deep detail so that I can actually perform the calculations without needing to ask it again.